

EIC SCHOOL · BRAVE NEW WORLD SERIES

Causative Verbs

make · have · let · get

Grammar reference and practice. Complete the exercises and bring this sheet to your next class.

Student name

Date

01 · WARM-UP

Three questions to think about before the grammar.

Answer in writing. There are no correct answers — but some are more examined than others.

Q1 Do you think society conditions people to want specific things — or do people genuinely choose their own desires?

Context: Huxley / Bernays Aldous Huxley argued that the most efficient control is one where people love their own conditioning. Edward Bernays spent his career manufacturing desire by attaching products to identity and freedom. Neither believed desire was simply natural.

→ If your desires were designed for you — would they feel any different from the inside?

Q2 When you use your phone, your social media feed, or a streaming platform — do you feel in control of what you want, or does the platform shape your wanting?

Context: Zuboff / Han Shoshana Zuboff argues that platforms predict and produce desire — they do not merely respond to it. Byung-Chul Han adds that the achievement society has internalised its demands so thoroughly that the cage feels like ambition.

→ Can you name one thing you wanted before the algorithm suggested it to you?

Q3 Which causative verb best describes your relationship with the things you feel you 'have to' do: make, have, let, or get?

Context: Frankfurt / Huxley Harry Frankfurt distinguished between wanting something and wanting to want it. Genuine freedom requires the capacity to reflect on your desires and endorse — or refuse — them. The choice of causative verb is already a philosophical position.

→ *Is there a difference between 'the system makes me' and 'I let the system'? Does that difference matter?*

02 · GRAMMAR REFERENCE

The four causative verbs.

make

Force / No choice

Structure: **make + person + bare infinitive**

- *Soma makes you feel nothing.*
- *The World State makes citizens consume constantly.*
- *What makes you want the things you want?*

have

Arrange / Delegate

Structure: **have + person + bare infinitive have + thing + past participle**

- *The state has citizens conditioned before birth.*
- *The algorithm has your desires designed for you.*
- *Lyra has her feed curated every morning.*

let

Permit / Allow

Structure: **let + person + bare infinitive**

- *The World State lets you believe you are free.*
- *The platform lets you think you chose the content.*
- *Consumer culture lets you feel like an individual.*

get

Persuade / Convince

Structure: **get + person + to + infinitive get + thing + past participle**

- *Bernays got women to smoke.*
- *The attention economy gets you to stay on platform.*
- *How did the system get people to want their own cage?*

Key differences

	make	have	let	get
Core idea	Force	Arrange	Permit	Persuade
Form	bare inf.	bare inf. / past part.	bare inf.	to + inf.
Agency	None	Minimal	They could — permitted	Some — persuaded

have / get something done — the agent disappears

When you use **have something done** or **get something done**, you are not doing it yourself. Someone else acts — and that person often disappears from the sentence entirely.

have something done	get something done
<i>Arrange for someone else. The agent is unnamed.</i>	<i>Similar to have, but implies more effort on your part.</i>
· I had my apartment cleaned. (a cleaner did it)	· I got my phone fixed. (a technician did it)

· Lyra has her feed curated. (the algorithm does it)	· She got her article published. (an editor did it)
· Citizens have their desires designed. (the system acts on them)	· Bernays got the idea sold. (the media sold it)

Key point: the subject of have/get something done is who arranged it — not who did it. In Huxley's world: citizens have their identities designed, desires curated, happiness arranged. The system that acts never appears in the sentence.

03 · PRACTICE

Ten exercises.

Complete each sentence using the correct causative verb. Write your full answer in the space.

- 01 Soma _____ people _____ nothing. No one chooses to feel numb — the drug produces the effect directly.
- 02 The World State _____ citizens _____ they are free. No bars visible, no force used — just permission granted.
- 03 Bernays _____ women _____ smoke by reframing cigarettes as symbols of independence. He persuaded — he did not force.
- 04 In the World State, citizens _____ their desires _____ for them before birth. They are the objects, not the agents.
- 05 Postman argued television didn't ban serious ideas — it simply _____ serious discourse _____ boring by comparison.
- 06 The algorithm _____ you _____ you curated your own feed. One tap and the choices feel yours.
- 07 How does a system _____ people _____ their own surveillance? By making it feel like a convenience.
- 08 Lyra _____ her apartment _____ each week. She pays for the service, but she didn't design the aesthetic.
- 09 Consumer culture _____ you _____ dissatisfied before offering the solution. The gap is manufactured first.
- 10 Something _____ Marcus _____ inside the cage. Choose your verb carefully — the answer says something about agency.

04 · HOMEWORK

Before the next class.

Three tasks. Write your answers here and bring this sheet to the lesson.

Task 01 · Transform

Rewrite each sentence using a causative verb. Do not look at the reference section first.

- 1 The system forces people to consume things they do not need.

- 2 The state arranged for citizens to be conditioned before birth.

- 3 The platform permits you to believe the feed is yours.

- 4 Bernays persuaded women to see cigarettes as freedom.

Task 02 · Error Correction

Each sentence has one error. Find it, correct it, and write the full corrected sentence.

- 1 Soma makes people to feel nothing.

- 2 The algorithm lets you to curate your own feed.

- 3 The state got citizens accept their conditioning.

- 4 Lyra has her apartment been cleaned every week.

Task 03 · Free Writing

Write 4–6 sentences about your own life using causative verbs. Use at least three different ones. Consider: what makes you do things you would rather not do? What does the system let you believe? What has been arranged for you that you did not choose?